

competition-playbook

NDAIE 2026 — Competition Playbook
(Immediate Focus)

Source: NASS National Innovation Pitch Challenge — Official Rulebook (binding) + Participant and Judge Guidelines. Expo: National Drone & Aerospace Innovation Expo 2026, Lagos, 27–28 Nov 2026. Application deadline: **26 Sept 2026, 23:59 WAT** (online form + 300-word summary + max 10-slide PDF deck).

Where Rulebook and Guidelines conflict, **Rulebook takes precedence.**

1. What We Are Entering

- Project: **AeroPulse-NG** — air-gapped, offline-first tactical radar & airspace surveillance engine (commodity SDR + PC → dual-window ATC/tactical workstation).
- Category: **Flight Planning & Air Traffic Management** (confirmed).
 - Pitch angle: real-time low-altitude traffic picture, conflict detection (STCA), micro-weather fusion for aerodromes without justified radar, offline by design.
 - Fallback category if NASS reassigns: Autonomous Systems & Smart Avionics.
- Team: 2–5 student sub-team drawn from BOLTE (see `eligibility-tracker.md`). BOLTE has 7 total — **only registered 2–5 may present.**

2. Stages & Dates (WAT)

Stage	What happens	Target date	Owner
Application	Form + summary + deck submitted	26 Sept 2026 23:59	Team Lead
Qualification	Eligible entries screened vs rubric, qualifiers notified	By 8 Oct 2026	NASS

Stage	What happens	Target date	Owner
Quarter-finals	Top 40% of qualified submit 2-min video demo / walk-through via NASS link	14 Oct 2026	Sub-team
Semi-finals	10 teams virtual presentation	28 Oct 2026	Sub-team
Live finals	Top 5 present at NDAIE Lagos, ≥1 registered member must attend	27 Nov 2026	Sub-team
Awards	Top 3 recognised	28 Nov 2026	NASS

Internal buffer: **freeze deck + summary by 19 Sept, internal review 22 Sept, submit 25 Sept.**

3. Rubric Mapping (score 1–10 each, weighted)

- Clarity of Problem & Solution — 25%
- Technical Feasibility & Innovation — 25%
- Potential Impact — 20%
- Quality of Presentation / Pitch Deck — 15%
- Overall Readiness & Execution — 15%

Strategy: lead with specific Nigerian problem (imported PSR/SSR cost, low-altitude/terrain-shadow gaps, harmattan/diversion failures), show one decode path (sim == real), honest TRL 4–5, deterministic replayable core, standards map (Nig.CARs, ICAO Annex 2/5/10 Vol III, Doc 4444 5NM/1000ft, DO-260B, MIL-STD-2525D), offline + NCAA SI-metric compliance, education/sovereignty impact.

4. Submission Checklist

- ☐ Sub-team of 2–5 confirmed eligible (age 16–30, enrolled Nigerian school, DOB + email roster)
- ☐ Team Lead designated as official contact, entry reference saved
- ☐ Title + primary category selected
- ☐ Executive summary ≤300 words (problem/solution/approach/impact) — see `executive-summary-300w.md`

- ☐ Deck ≤10 slides PDF, one idea per slide — see `pitch-deck-outline-10-slides.md`
- ☐ Originality checked, third-party IP cleared, generative AI use disclosed, conflicts declared
- ☐ No duplicate/materially similar entry from same team combination
- ☐ Confirmation email + reference received

5. Rules & Integrity Notes

- Plagiarism / fabrication / misrepresentation = disqualification at any stage.
- IEEE citation style for any research references.
- Participants retain IP; entry grants NASS non-exclusive royalty-free licence to use abstracts/decks/videos/photos as reasonably required to run, evaluate, report, promote. Non-progressing entries not made public by NASS; qualified/finalist materials may be shared in Expo programme.
- Do not put trade secrets in public materials. Mark confidential annexes separately and do not upload them.
- Professional conduct required; finalist no-show without prior authorisation = forfeiture.
- Judging: panel average, ties by discussion. No score-based appeals. Integrity concerns in writing to nassnigeriaofficial@gmail.com.
- Get binding info only from official NASS channels / email. Social DMs not binding.

6. Next Actions (this week)

1. Fill `eligibility-tracker.md` — block all other work until sub-team is legal.
2. Finalise summary + deck outline, assign slide owners.
3. Record backup 2-min demo early (synthetic-feed mode — no RF hardware needed to pitch).
4. Sign internal NDA + IP assignment before sharing deck externally.

BOLTE Corporate Documentation — template/draft (requires review where noted)

NASS Rulebook takes precedence for competition matters